



At Ministry of Ports, Shipping, and Waterways, we are actively driving the development of India's Blue Economy. Since 2014, our efforts have led to unprecedented growth, including doubling port capacity, a remarkable reduction in Container Vessel Turnaround Time, global recognition with ports ranking among the Top 30, improved logistics performance, reduced logistics costs, a substantial increase in cargo handling through national waterways, and a fourfold rise in cruise tourism. The strategic utilization of private sector efficiencies and investments has been instrumental in advancing India's maritime prowess. Looking ahead, the Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047 sets the stage for cutting-edge Deep Draft Mega Ports and Trans-shipment Hubs, positioning India as a leading maritime force globally.

Sh. T K Ramachandran, IAS
Secretary, Ministry of Ports
Shipping and Waterways

The elevation of these ports on the global stage underscores India's emergence as a major player in the international maritime arena. **Logistics performance**, a crucial determinant of a nation's trade efficiency, has witnessed a substantial ascent. From the 54th rank, Indian logistics performance has climbed to the **38th rank**, indicating a more streamlined and effective movement of goods within the country. This improvement not only enhances India's competitiveness but also contributes to the overall efficiency of global supply chains. Furthermore, the focus on optimizing logistics has resulted in a significant **reduction in logistics costs** which is less than 10% of GDP in 2023.

Moreover, Cargo handling through national waterways has witnessed an astonishing **18-fold increase**, reaching an impressive **126 million tonnes per annum**. This surge in waterway transportation not only eases the burden on traditional modes but also aligns with sustainable practices. The government's strategic initiatives have also fostered growth in in **cruise tourism** as annual cruise passengers have **nearly quadrupled**, reaching a substantial figure of **3.08 lakhs per annum**. This surge not only boosts the tourism industry but also amplifies the economic impact on coastal regions. Crucially, the government's emphasis on private sector participation through **Public-Private Partnerships (PPP)** has yielded substantial results. Operationalized PPP projects in Indian ports have more than doubled, surpassing an impressive value of **Rs. 40,000 Crores**. This infusion of private sector efficiencies and investments has not only accelerated the pace of port infrastructure development but has also ensured a more robust and sustainable maritime ecosystem.

Government's Key Maritime Infrastructure and Policy Enablers

This significant shift witnessed in India's maritime sector can be ascribed to government's strategic policy initiatives and infrastructural interventions wherein at the forefront is the **Sagarmala Programme**, launched in 2015. This comprehensive program, currently encompassing **more than 830 projects** with a staggering investment exceeding **Rs. 5.7 Lakh Crore,** operates on a five-pillared approach, strategically designed to address critical aspects of maritime growth. Firstly, **Port Modernization** seeks to enhance the efficiency and capacity of existing ports, ensuring they meet global standards. Simultaneously, **Port Connectivity** focuses on seamlessly integrating ports with hinterland regions, optimizing transportation networks for enhanced accessibility. **Port-led Industrialization** is another pivotal pillar, aiming to establish thriving industrial clusters in proximity to ports. **Coastal Community Development** is another pillar ensuring inclusive growth. **Coastal Shipping-Inland Waterways Transport**, the fifth pillar, promotes the use of waterways for cargo transportation, offering an environmentally sustainable alternative and further reducing logistics costs.

Another landmark legislative measure by the government is the **Major Ports Authorities Act 2021** along with **Revision of Model Concession Agreement** for PPP projects (MCA 2021), empowering PPP concessionaires with the **freedom to set tariffs** based on prevailing market conditions. This forward-thinking approach enhances the operational flexibility of port authorities, facilitating a more responsive and competitive ecosystem. The objective is to create a conducive environment for private sector participation, optimizing efficiency and encouraging sustainable investments in port infrastructure. In addition, the **Financial Assistance Policy on Shipbuilding** is a notable intervention towards fostering self-reliance **(Aatmanirbharta)** in shipbuilding. Under this policy, a substantial financial assistance is extended to Indian shipyards, providing a significant impetus to indigenous shipbuilding capabilities.



Over the past decade, the Sagarmala Programme has played a pivotal role in significantly reducing India's logistics costs to less than 10% of the GDP. With a robust portfolio of projects, we are actively driving the modernization of our ports under Sagarmala with an objective of not just enhancing India's Port capacity but also reducing the cost of cargo handling operations. The goal is to establish them as World Class Deep Draft Mega Ports, reshaping the landscape of maritime infrastructure.

Sh. Bhushan Kumar
Joint Secretary-Sagarmala, Ministry of Ports,
Shipping and Waterways